Furthermore, their existence means that Lashkar would remain able to support or execute attacks against India were Pakistan to crack down on its domestic infrastructure. Should this occur, these networks also could be unleashed on the many countries they currently permeate, or on Pakistan.

Lashkar is unlikely to launch attacks inside Pakistan short of a sudden volte-face by the state and an attempt to smash the group. Yet that does not mean Pakistan is immune to the consequences of Lashkar's violence. Its involvement in a terrorist attack against America or one of its allies would imperil US-Pakistan relations, and could lead to retaliatory action. Another terrorist spectacular in India is of potentially greater concern. War between two nuclear powers was avoided after the Mumbai attacks, but it is questionable whether any government in New Delhi would show similar restraint were India to suffer another mass casualty attack at Lashkar's hands. For these reasons, some of those with whom the author spoke in the Pakistani security establishment evinced unease about the group's activities. Nor should one forget the impact that its non-violent activities have on Pakistan. Members of the security establishment have implied to the author that one day, provided Kashmir is settled appropriately, JuD could be used as a mechanism to move Lashkar fighters toward non-violence. However, many local interlocutors fear the long-term threat to moderate values in the country even more than they do Lashkar's martial capabilities. Although the group had only limited success at converting people to its interpretation of Ahl-e-Hadith Islam, 'JuD is steadily eating into Pakistan's social fabric' to quote one prominent journalist.[10] Yet its above-ground operations continue relatively unchecked. Meanwhile, the army and ISI continue attempting merely to modulate the group's militant activities. Among the many problems with this approach is the fact that managing jihadis is more of an art than a science and ambiguous policies by nature create situations in which real control is impossible.

Dismantling Lashkar must be a gradual process in order to avoid provoking a major backlash that could destabilize the country. But there is no indication that such a process has been initiated. Pakistan's practice of abstaining from action against Lashkar is predicated partly on the desire to avoid driving it further into the insurgency. However, this presumes a level of organizational discipline that appears at odds with the ground reality. The group's policy remains to abjure attacks against the state, but the leadership's influence over some mid-level commanders and members of